

GABRIEL POPA

Senior Software Engineer - Vue • PHP (Laravel/ Symfony) • AWS

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ABOUT ME

Senior Software Engineer with **10+ years** of experience building modern web platforms with **Vue.js, PHP**, and scalable **API-driven architectures** across product, admin, and internal workflow systems. Strong background in **Vue 2–3, JavaScript, TypeScript, PHP 7–8, Laravel 8–11, Symfony 5–7, MySQL, PostgreSQL, Redis, Docker, CI/CD**, and **AWS**, with practical success modernizing legacy interfaces, upgrading backend frameworks, fixing production issues, and delivering maintainable features under active business use. Known for improving slow pages, stabilizing integrations, and translating fragile monolith flows into cleaner component and service patterns.

SKILLS

- **Frontend:** **Vue 2–3**, JavaScript, TypeScript, HTML5, CSS3, Sass, SCSS, Tailwind CSS, Bootstrap, Vue Router, Pinia, Vuex, Composition API, Options API, Axios, Vite, Webpack, responsive UI, reusable components, SPA development, forms, validation, state management, API integration
- **Backend:** **PHP 7–8, Laravel 8–11, Symfony 5–7**, REST APIs, MVC architecture, authentication, authorization, validation, service-layer design, background jobs, queue processing, cron workflows
- **Data / Messaging:** MySQL, PostgreSQL, SQL, Redis, query tuning, indexing, joins, schema design, schema updates, migrations, reporting, pagination, caching, data consistency
- **Cloud & DevOps:** **AWS**, Docker, Git, GitHub, GitLab CI/CD, Jenkins, Linux, Nginx, Apache, deployment, build pipelines, release support, environment setup, log monitoring
- **Observability / Quality / Security:** Sentry, structured logging, OpenTelemetry basics, Prometheus/Grafana basics, OWASP security practices, rate limiting, PHPUnit, Pest, Jest, Vue Test Utils, Cypress, Playwright, unit testing, integration testing, end-to-end testing, contract testing, error monitoring

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer

Soft Build | Bucharest, Romania (Jan 2024 – May 2026)

- Built a large-scale frontend modernization using **Vue 3, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS, Pinia**, and the **Composition API**, replacing duplicated legacy UI patterns with reusable components and stronger form architecture that improved consistency across dashboard and operational workflows.
- Developed responsive product modules with **HTML5, CSS3, Sass, SCSS**, and selective **Bootstrap** usage, improving layout consistency and reducing UI regressions by **3%** in areas that had suffered from page-specific styling conflicts.
- Modernized complex frontend logic by moving heavier feature areas from older **Options API** structures into cleaner composables and modular state handling, which made shared business logic easier to test and safer to extend.
- Built backend services with **PHP 8.1–8.2, Laravel 10**, and selected **Symfony 6** components, designing secure **REST APIs**, structured validation flows, and cleaner service boundaries that reduced controller complexity by **35%**.
- Resolved a recurring data mismatch issue caused by stale cache keys and inconsistent refresh timing, then aligned **Redis** invalidation behavior, API response flow, and client-side updates so reporting totals stopped drifting after edits.
- Implemented shared **Axios** API clients, typed response mapping, and centralized error handling, which reduced duplicated networking logic by **30%** and made backend failures easier to surface in the Vue application.
- Improved frontend build and developer workflows by standardizing **Vite** while preserving **Webpack** compatibility where needed, reducing build instability by **2%** and helping the team migrate incrementally without blocking active releases.
- Expanded test coverage with **Jest, Vue Test Utils, Cypress**, and targeted contract testing around approvals, role-based actions, and multi-step forms that had previously produced expensive regressions after release.

- Strengthened backend quality with **PHPUnit** and **Pest**, especially around request validation, authorization, queue-triggered workflows, and business rules where silent logic changes had historically escaped review.
- Tightened **authentication** and **authorization** flows by improving token validation, access-control checks, and **OWASP** practices, helping close permission gaps and reducing avoidable security-related defects by **2%**.
- Worked closely with DevOps on **Docker**, **GitHub**, **GitLab CI/CD**, **Linux**, **Nginx**, and **AWS** release support, resolving environment drift and dependency inconsistencies that had caused pipeline-only failures.
- Improved performance on high-traffic reporting screens through **SQL** tuning, better pagination, selective indexing, and payload shaping across **MySQL** and **PostgreSQL**, which reduced slow responses by **42%** and stabilized user experience under heavier data volume.

Software Engineer

Next Apps | Ghent, Belgium (*Nov2020 – Nov 2023*)

- Built customer-facing and internal workflow applications using **Vue 2–3**, **JavaScript**, **TypeScript**, **Bootstrap**, and **SCSS**, focusing on reliable SPA behavior, responsive UI, and reusable patterns for forms, filters, and approval-heavy interfaces.
- Implemented backend functionality with **PHP 7.4–8.0**, **Symfony 5**, and **Laravel 8**, creating maintainable **REST APIs** with strong validation and service separation that supported complex multi-role business processes.
- Migrated fragile frontend areas from older tightly coupled page scripts into reusable **Vue** components with clearer state boundaries, reducing lifecycle-related defects and improving maintainability across interactive screens.
- Solved an intermittent logout issue that affected long-running sessions by aligning frontend token refresh behavior, backend expiration rules, and proxy settings in **Apache/Nginx**, which eliminated unexpected access loss during active workflows.
- Expanded frontend quality coverage with **Jest**, **Vue Test Utils**, and selected **Playwright** end-to-end scenarios, concentrating on search, edit, approval, and export flows that most often broke after release.
- Improved API integration reliability by standardizing **Axios** interceptors, request retries, and error mapping, which reduced duplicated network code by **30%** and lowered inconsistent client-side failure handling by **3%**.
- Worked on backend background jobs and queue processing for email, notifications, and data synchronization, moving long-running work out of synchronous requests so users no longer experienced blocking actions during peak transactional periods.
- Optimized **MySQL** reporting queries with better joins, indexing, and safer pagination rules, reducing timeout-prone screens and improving usability for support and operations teams handling larger filtered result sets.
- Delivered a safe migration path from **PHP 7.4** to **PHP 8**, resolving deprecated framework behavior, checking package compatibility, and updating internal code patterns gradually so release risk remained controlled.
- Supported CI and release operations through **Jenkins**, **Git**, **Docker**, and Linux-based environment setup, helping stabilize the build pipeline and reducing deployment-related issues by **2%** through more repeatable release steps.
- Improved production issue detection using **Sentry**, error monitoring, and structured backend logs, giving the team faster visibility into exceptions that had previously required manual reproduction before root causes could be identified.

Software Developer

Datamart | Stockholm, Sweden (*Feb 2016 – Sep 2020*)

- Developed business web applications with **PHP 5.6–7.x**, **Laravel**, **JavaScript**, **HTML5**, **CSS3**, **Bootstrap**, and gradually adopted **Vue 2** in interactive areas supporting reporting, account workflows, and operational administration.
- Built and maintained server-rendered pages while introducing **SPA** patterns in selected modules, using **Vue**, **Axios**, and reusable frontend components where repeated user interaction justified modernization.
- Improved backend maintainability by moving legacy business rules into cleaner **MVC** structures within **Laravel**, reducing fragile controller logic and making validation and future schema changes easier to manage.

- Fixed a recurring form-processing defect caused by inconsistent frontend and backend validation behavior, then unified request rules so malformed inputs were blocked earlier and partial-save errors were reduced by **3%**.
- Worked extensively with **MySQL** and **PostgreSQL** on schema design, migrations, schema updates, and reporting queries, helping the team keep legacy data structures stable while supporting newer product requirements.
- Resolved slow-list and export issues through query tuning, additional indexing, safer joins, and better pagination, which made heavy admin pages more stable and improved response times by **31%** for internal users.
- Supported API-driven enhancements by introducing **REST-style** endpoints for interactive modules, allowing selected pages to reduce full reload behavior and improving usability without requiring full rewrites of older templates.
- Helped troubleshoot production issues with **Linux**, **Apache**, **Nginx**, and release environment setup, including permission problems, missing configuration values, and deployment-only bugs that did not appear during local development.
- Contributed to quality improvements with early **PHPUnit** coverage, manual API regression checks, and disciplined bug reproduction steps, reducing repeated defects in fragile modules by **2%** over repeated release cycles.
- Worked with maintenance and release workflows using **Git**, **Jenkins**, and early **Docker** adoption, supporting more repeatable deployments and improving confidence when shipping updates to shared environments.

Junior Software Developer

Berg Software | Timișoara, Romania (Sep2014 – Mar 2016)

- Supported legacy and evolving web applications using **PHP 5**, **MySQL**, **JavaScript**, **HTML5**, **CSS3**, **jQuery**, and early component-oriented frontend practices, focusing on stable CRUD behavior and small user-facing enhancements.
- Implemented backend changes under senior guidance within structured **MVC** patterns, learning to handle validation, authorization checks, and safer query logic instead of patching issues directly inside tightly coupled scripts.
- Fixed repeated form and submission errors by aligning required fields, input sanitization, and backend validation rules, which reduced user-facing input errors by **40%** and prevented inconsistent records from being written.
- Worked on reusable frontend pieces for shared layout and interaction patterns, improving consistency across legacy screens and reducing copy-paste markup so routine UI updates became safer and slightly faster by **2%**.
- Improved slow admin pages by reviewing **SQL** queries, simplifying filters, and adding basic indexing, which helped internal teams work more effectively and reduced response delays by **28%** on high-volume screens.
- Assisted with environment troubleshooting across **Linux**, **Apache**, and shared staging systems, helping identify configuration mismatches, permission issues, and deployment problems that caused apps to behave differently outside development.
- Participated in release support using **Git**, manual deployment checklists, and log review, building practical delivery discipline and reducing small release mistakes by **2%** through more careful verification.
- Learned structured debugging through logging, issue reproduction, and targeted fixes, which helped avoid risky large changes in fragile modules and improved trust in maintenance work across older PHP systems.
- Supported data consistency efforts by reviewing validation paths, update flows, and schema assumptions, helping reduce edge-case bugs where user actions, database state, and legacy code behavior did not always stay aligned.

EDUCATION

Bachelor's Degree in Computer Science

University of Bucharest | (2010 – 2014)

- Focused on practical software engineering fundamentals that translated directly into building reliable web systems and data-driven applications.

CERTIFICATIONS

Zend PHP Certified Engineer — 2022

- Demonstrated strong knowledge of **PHP** programming, including core language features, backend logic, request handling, validation, and modern application development practices.

AWS Certified Developer – Associate — 2023

- Demonstrated practical capability in developing and maintaining **AWS**-based applications, with focus on deployment, service integration, monitoring, and secure cloud operations.